

Share It Forward.

A spec campaign concept by Sresha Rajesh — not affiliated with or endorsed by The Coca-Cola Company

CLIENT	Coca-Cola (growth marketing / referral loop concept)
CAMPAIGN TYPE	Referral growth loop, built on the Share a Coke personalization mechanic
DELIVERABLES	Interactive referral-loop tool · App UI mockups · This case study
STATUS	Spec campaign — independent concept work, not a real client engagement

The Opportunity

Share a Coke is one of the most studied personalization campaigns in CPG marketing history — a name on a bottle, rolled out to 80+ countries since its 2011 Australia launch. But the original mechanic was built for a world before referral-loop growth tactics were standard: it made people want to buy a bottle with a friend's name on it, but it never gave the sender and receiver a shared, trackable reason to both come back.

"Share It Forward" takes the same proven personalization insight and rebuilds it as an actual growth loop: a give-one-get-one mechanic, measured the way a growth team would measure it, not just the way a brand team would.

Why This, Why Now

- Share a Coke's original Australia launch (2011) is estimated by Ogilvy to have lifted Coke's category share by 4% and consumption among young adults by 7%.
- In the US, the campaign is credited with a 2%+ sales increase, reversing more than a decade of declining Coke consumption — proof the personalization insight travels and converts.
- Coca-Cola already has the infrastructure this needs: an owned app and a rewards/redemption flow at Coca-Cola.com/offers, the successor to My Coke Rewards — this campaign proposes using that existing rail for a referral mechanic rather than asking for new infrastructure.

The Idea

Let someone personalize a virtual bottle for a friend and send it through the Coca-Cola App. Opening it unlocks a reward for the receiver; completing the loop (receiver redeems, or sends their own) unlocks a reward for the original sender too. The whole mechanic is visible to the user as a simple loop dashboard — sends, opens, rewards unlocked — rather than hidden in the backend the way most referral programs are.

Deliverables Prototyped

- Share It Forward referral tool — an interactive prototype where someone personalizes a bottle for a friend and sees a simulated version of their own growth loop (referrals sent, estimated virality, reward status).
- App UI mockups — three Coca-Cola App screens: the send flow, a loop-status dashboard making the referral mechanic visible to the user, and a reward wallet routed through the real Coca-Cola.com/offers redemption flow.

How This Would Be Measured

Because this is spec work, there's no real spend or real results to report. Here's how I'd actually measure it if it ran:

- Primary KPI: K-factor / viral coefficient — average number of referrals sent per existing participant, and what share of those convert into a new app user or redemption.
- Secondary KPI: loop completion rate (sent → opened → redeemed or re-sent), and blended CAC comparing referral-driven signups against paid-acquisition signups.
- Channels: in-app referral flow as the primary surface, QR codes on-pack linking directly into the personalizer, light paid social retargeting aimed only at users who started but didn't complete a referral.
- Budget split (illustrative): 50% lifecycle/CRM (in-app and push, since the loop is largely self-propagating), 30% on-pack QR/production tie-in, 20% paid retargeting to rescue incomplete loops.
- Test plan: A/B test the reward size and type (give-one-get-one discount vs. exclusive early access to a Coca-Cola Creations flavor) to find the point where incremental reward spend stops producing incremental referrals.

A Note on Accuracy

The Share a Coke facts referenced here — the 2011 Australia launch, the 80+ country rollout, Ogilvy's 4%/7% Australia estimates, and the 2%+ US sales lift reversing a 10-year decline — are drawn from public reporting (Wikipedia, citing contemporaneous coverage) and were fact-checked before publishing. The Coca-Cola.com/offers rewards flow referenced is Coca-Cola's real, current redemption mechanism (successor to My Coke Rewards). The referral-loop mechanic, app screens, and all projected growth metrics are original creative work and are clearly not real performance data.